

3.2 Pathogens, immunity and disease control

In this section, learners study the nature of pathogens and their means of transmission. An understanding of the primary defences and immunological responses of the body to infection, and the management and treatment of communicable diseases will also be considered, including the challenges of controlling the spread of drug-resistant strains. Learners will also gain an appreciation of the need for epidemiological research in this dynamic and changing area of science, and evaluate the associated risks and benefits to the individual and to society.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills gained in this section to new situations and/or to solve related problems.